

Word family: **book / books / booked / booking / bookable / booking**

Base word: book

Plural: books

Past tense: booked

Past participle: booked

** -ing form:** booking

Related forms: booking, bookable

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “He loves talking about old Hong Kong, unusual people he interviewed, **books**, films, and the tiny details that most of us walk straight past.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **books** means **written works that people read**, usually published as printed or digital works.

The speaker is describing one of the subjects Mr. Wong enjoys discussing.

繁體中文： **以文字為主要內容、供人閱讀的完整出版作品，例如小說、傳記、歷史書或其他讀物**

中文翻譯：

> “He loves talking about old Hong Kong, unusual people he interviewed, **books**, films...”

「他很喜歡談舊香港、他曾經訪問過的特別人物、**書籍 / 讀物**、電影……」

Here:

book = 以文字內容為主、供人閱讀的完整作品或出版物

1. **book = written work/publication (書籍 / 著作) — 書 ; 書籍 ; 著作**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: A written work intended to be read, whether in printed or electronic form.

Practice 1 — Original

> “He loves talking about **books**, films, and the tiny details that most of us walk straight past.”

「他很喜歡談**書籍**、電影，以及那些大部分人會直接忽略的小細節。」

Practice 2

> “She is reading a **book** about the history of Hong Kong.”

「她正在讀一本有關香港歷史的**書**。」

Practice 3

> “His latest **book** became very popular.”

「他最新出版的**著作 / 書**非常受歡迎。」

****book = 以文字內容構成並作為完整作品出版、供人閱讀的讀物****

Common examples:

- * history book
- * children's book
- * reference book
- * electronic book / e-book
- * write a book
- * publish a book
- * read a book

These are one underlying sense.

2. ****book = physical volume of bound pages (實體書本) — 一本實體書；冊子****

Sometimes ****book**** focuses less on the intellectual work and more on the ****physical object consisting of pages bound together****.

Practice 4

> “There were several heavy ****books**** on the table.”

「桌上放着幾本厚重的****書本****。」

Practice 5

> “She opened the ****book**** and turned to page fifty.”

「她打開**書本**，翻到第五十頁。」

book = 由多頁紙張裝訂而成、可以拿在手中閱讀或書寫的實體物件

This is very closely connected to Meaning 1.

For database purposes, I would **not** count it as a completely independent core meaning unless you specifically want to distinguish:

> **the intellectual work**

> versus

> **the physical copy**

The Golden Manual tells us not to over-split when one broad concept naturally explains closely related uses.

3. **book** + hotel/table/ticket/appointment (酒店 / 座位 / 票 / 預約) — 預訂 ; 預約

This is the major verb meaning.

Meaning: To arrange in advance for a place, service, seat, ticket, appointment, etc. to be available for you.

Practice 6

> “We **booked** a hotel near the station.”

「我們在車站附近**預訂**了一間酒店。」

Practice 7

> “You should **book** an appointment before visiting the clinic.”

「去診所之前，你應該先**預約**。」

book something = 提前作出安排，確保某個座位、房間、服務、行程或時間段留給自己使用

Common:

* book a room

* book a table

* book a flight

* book tickets

* book an appointment

* book a holiday

These are one broad **reservation** meaning.

4. **book + person/performer/professional (人物 / 表演者 / 專業人士) — 預約 ; 聘請 ; 安排出席**

Book can also mean arranging for a person to provide a service, perform, or appear at a particular time.

Practice 8

> “They **booked** a band for the wedding.”

「他們為婚禮**聘請 / 預約了一支樂隊演出**。」

Practice 9

> “The television programme **booked** several well-known guests.”

「這個電視節目**安排了幾位知名嘉賓出演**。」

book someone = 預先安排某人提供服務、表演或在某個活動中出席

This grows directly from the reservation meaning:

> reserve a service/time → reserve a person's professional time

So I would treat it as a **contextual branch of Meaning 3**, not inflate the core count.

5. **book = officially enter something in a record/system (正式記錄) — 登記 ; 記錄在案**

This is an older underlying sense that still appears in several important modern contexts.

Meaning: To officially enter someone's name, details, transaction, offence, etc. into a record or system.

Practice 10

> “The payment was **booked** as an operating expense.”

「這筆款項被**記錄為營運開支**。」

Practice 11

> “All transactions must be properly **booked** in the system.”

「所有交易都必須在系統內妥善**登記 / 入帳**。」

book something = 把某項資料、交易或事項正式記錄到紀錄、帳目或系統中

This sense explains several specialized uses below.

6. **book someone** (警方) — 正式登記罪名 / 拘捕後立案

In police and legal contexts, **book** can mean formally recording a person and the alleged offence after arrest.

Practice 12

> “He was arrested and **booked** at the police station.”

「他被捕後在警署**正式登記立案**。」

Practice 13

> “The suspect was **booked** on several charges.”

「疑犯因數項控罪被**正式登記 / 立案處理**。」

book someone = 警方在拘捕後正式記錄疑犯身份及涉嫌罪名

This is an established modern meaning, particularly common in American English and crime reporting.

Semantically, it develops from:

> **officially enter someone in a record**

but because the learner interpretation is very different, it deserves explicit treatment.

7. **book a player** (體育) — 記名警告 ; 出示黃牌

In football and some other sports, especially British English, a referee can **book** a player.

Practice 14

> “The referee **booked** the defender for a late challenge.”

「球證因那名後衛的一次遲來攔截而向他**出示黃牌 / 記名警告**。」

Practice 15

> “Two players were **booked** during the first half.”

「上半場有兩名球員被**黃牌警告 / 記名警告**。」

book a player = 球證正式記錄球員的違規行為並給予警告，通常即出示黃牌

Again, historically and semantically this comes from **official recording**, but for learners it is a sufficiently specialized and non-obvious interpretation to show separately.

8. **the books / accounts** (財務紀錄) — 帳簿；帳目

As a plural noun, **books** can mean a business's financial records.

Practice 16

> “The accountant checked the company's **books**.”

「會計師檢查了公司的**帳簿 / 財務紀錄**。」

Practice 17

> “The figures in the **books** did not match the bank records.”

「**帳目**中的數字與銀行紀錄不相符。」

the books = 公司或機構用來記錄收入、支出、資產及其他財務交易的帳目紀錄

This is different from:

> “I bought three books.”

= 我買了三本書。

In:

> “The accountant checked the books.”

the accountant is not reviewing novels.

9. **on the books (正式記錄 / 現行) — 記錄在案 ; 正式存在**

This is a useful fixed expression related to record-keeping.

Practice 18

> “The law has been **on the books** for decades.”

「這項法律已經**正式存在 / 載於法例中**數十年。」

Practice 19

> “The company still has hundreds of employees **on its books**.”

「公司正式紀錄中仍有數百名**在冊員工**。」

on the books = 已正式記錄、登記或列入某個機構的紀錄中

This is best treated as a fixed-expression extension rather than a separate core meaning.

Related form: **booking**

Booking has several common uses connected to the reservation meaning.

booking = reservation (預訂 / 預約)

Practice 20

> “I have a **booking** for two people at seven.”

「我預訂了晚上七時的兩人座位。」

Practice 21

> “Hotel **bookings** rise sharply during the summer.”

「夏季的酒店**預訂數量**大幅增加。」

****booking = 預先保留房間、座位、服務或時間的安排 / 紀錄****

**booking = professional engagement (工作 / 演出安排) **

Practice 22

> “The singer has several ****bookings**** this month.”

「那位歌手本月有幾個****演出安排****。」

Practice 23

> “The agency handles all of her professional ****bookings****.”

「這間代理公司處理她所有的專業****工作 / 演出預約****。」

This inherits the same broad reservation concept.

Related form: **bookable**

****Bookable**** means something can be reserved in advance.

Practice 24

> “These rooms are ****bookable**** online.”

「這些房間可以在網上****預訂****。」

Practice 25

> “The service is only ****bookable**** through the app.”

「這項服務只能透過應用程式****預約****。」

****bookable = 可以預先預訂、預約或保留的****

Important distinction: **book vs reserve**

These overlap strongly.

book

Very common for:

- * hotels
- * restaurants
- * flights
- * tickets
- * appointments
- * performers

> “I booked a room.”

reserve

also means arranging for something to be kept available.

> “I reserved a table.”

Reserve often sounds slightly more formal and also has broader meanings involving keeping something for later use.

But:

> **book a flight**

is extremely natural.

Important distinction: **book vs order**

These are not the same.

book

= arrange in advance to use a service, place, time, seat, etc.

> “We booked a table.”

order

= request that goods or food be supplied to you.

> “We ordered dinner.”

So:

> book a restaurant table ✓

> order a meal ✓

Different actions.

Important distinction: **book vs buy**

Booking something does **not** always mean you have already bought it.

> “I booked a hotel room.”

means:

I reserved it.

Payment may happen immediately, later, or at the hotel.

Similarly:

> “I booked an appointment.”

No ordinary concept of “buying” is required.

Important distinction: **a book vs the books**

a book / books

> “She reads a lot of books.”

= 書籍

the books

in business:

> “The accountant checked the books.”

= 帳目 / 財務紀錄

Context is therefore crucial.

Fixed expression: ****by the book****

This is a very common expression.

****Meaning:**** Following established rules or procedures exactly.

Practice 26

> “The inspector does everything ****by the book****.”

「那名督察做任何事情都****嚴格按照規則 / 程序辦事****。」

Practice 27

> “We need to handle this case ****by the book****.”

「我們需要****完全按照正式規定****處理這宗個案。」

****by the book = 嚴格按照正式規則、程序或規定行事****

This is a useful idiom, not another literal meaning of *book*.

Fixed expression: ****an open book****

****Meaning:**** A person whose feelings, thoughts, or life are easy to understand because they do not hide much.

Practice 28

> “She is an ****open book**** and rarely hides how she feels.”

「她是一個****很容易讓人看透、很少隱藏自己感受的人****。」

Practice 29

> “My life is an ****open book****.”

「我的生活****沒有甚麼秘密，很容易讓人了解****。」

Again, this belongs in the idiom/fixed-expression section rather than the core lexical count.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **book**
* **books**
* **booked**
* **booking**
* **bookable**

Useful compounds and lexical extensions include:

* **bookshop / bookstore**
* **bookshelf**
* **bookcase**
* **bookkeeping**
* **bookkeeper**
* **booking**
* **booking confirmation**

bookkeeping

= systematic recording of a business's financial transactions

bookkeeper

= person whose job is maintaining financial records

These connect especially strongly with the **financial records / books** sense.

Under the Golden Manual, common compounds and derivatives should be included when they add real learning value, but they should not be mislabeled as extra meanings of the base word.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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book — written work	以文字為主要內容並作為完整作品出版、供人閱讀的書籍或著作
book — physical volume	由多頁紙張裝訂而成、可以拿在手中閱讀或書寫的實體書本；與「作品」義高度相關
book a room/table/ticket/appointment	預先安排某個房間、座位、行程、服務或時間段留給

自己使用			
book a performer/professional		預先安排或聘請某人在指定時間提供服務、表演或出席	
book — officially record		把資料、交易、人物或事項正式登記在紀錄或系統中	
book someone — police		警方拘捕某人後正式記錄其身份及涉嫌罪名	
book a player — sport		球證正式記錄球員的違規並給予警告，通常即出示黃牌	
the books — accounts		公司或機構用來記錄收入、支出及其他財務交易的正式帳目	
booking		預先保留房間、座位、服務、時間或專業工作安排的紀錄	
bookable		可以預先預訂或預約的	
by the book		完全按照正式規則、程序或規定行事	
an open book		很少隱藏自己、思想或生活容易被別人了解的人	

For your original sentence

> “He loves talking about old Hong Kong, unusual people he interviewed, **books**, films...”

The exact meaning is:

book = 以文字為主要內容並供人閱讀的完整著作或出版物

So:

> **books and films**

= **書籍和電影**

For your database, I would count **5** genuinely useful core polysemy/polyfunctionality meanings for **book**:

1. **written work / physical book**
2. **reserve something in advance**
3. **officially record or enter something in a system**
4. **the books — financial accounts/records**
5. **specialized recorded-warning uses such as police booking or sports booking**, which grow from #3 but are important enough to flag separately for learners

I would **merge** **book a performer** into the reservation sense, and treat **by the book / an open book / on the books** as fixed expressions rather than inflate the core meaning count.